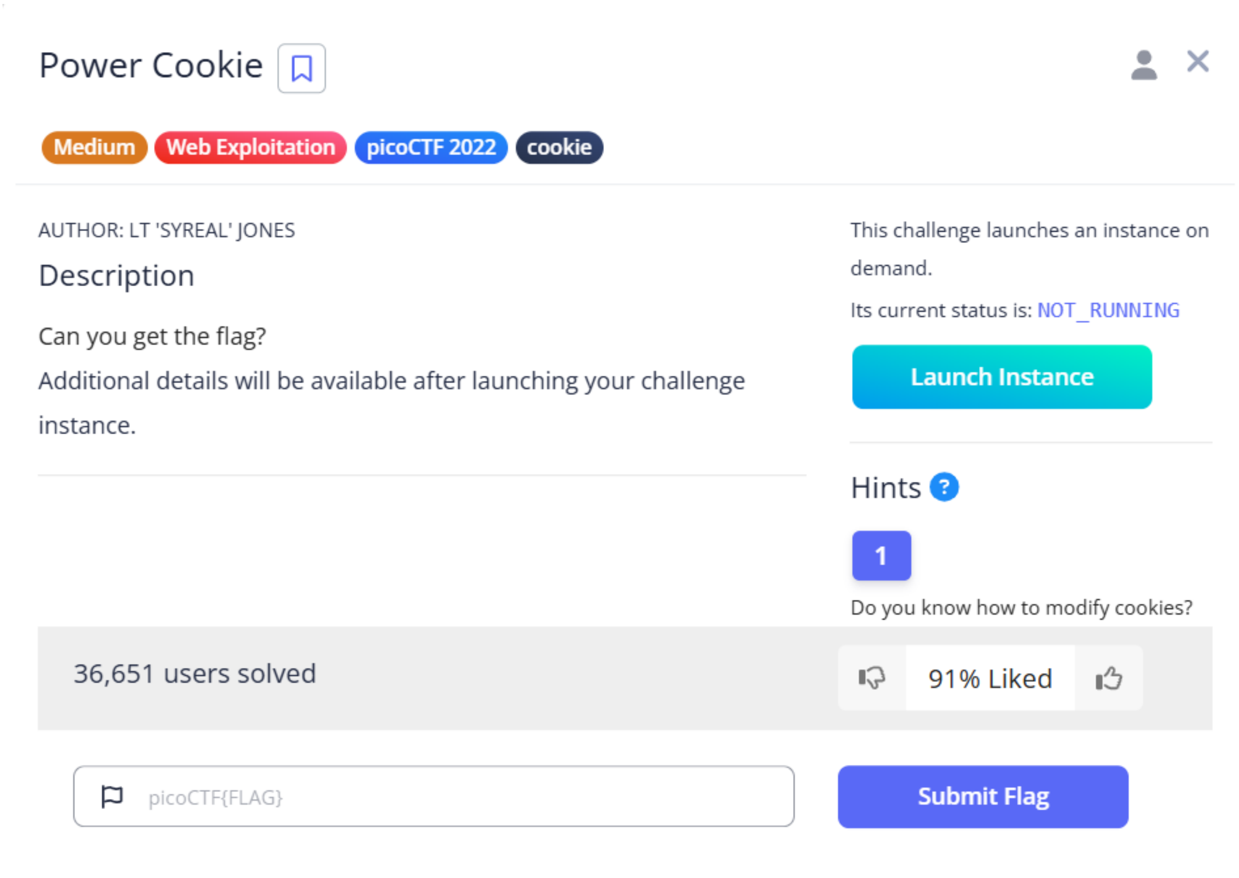
Saint Columban College
College of Computing Studies
Pagadian City

Power Cookie



Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: Power Cookie

Category: Web Exploitation

Date: 02/28/26

I. Objective

The objective of this challenge is to gain administrator access to the website in order to reveal the hidden flag.

This challenge aims to teach how **browser cookies** can be manipulated to bypass restrictions and access protected content.

II. Background

Websites often store small pieces of information called **cookies** inside the browser. These cookies help websites remember users and settings.

Some websites use cookies to determine whether a user is a **guest** or an **administrator**.

If a website does not properly secure its cookies, users may be able to change cookie values and gain unauthorized access.

In this challenge, the website uses a cookie to check if the user is an administrator.

III. Tool Used

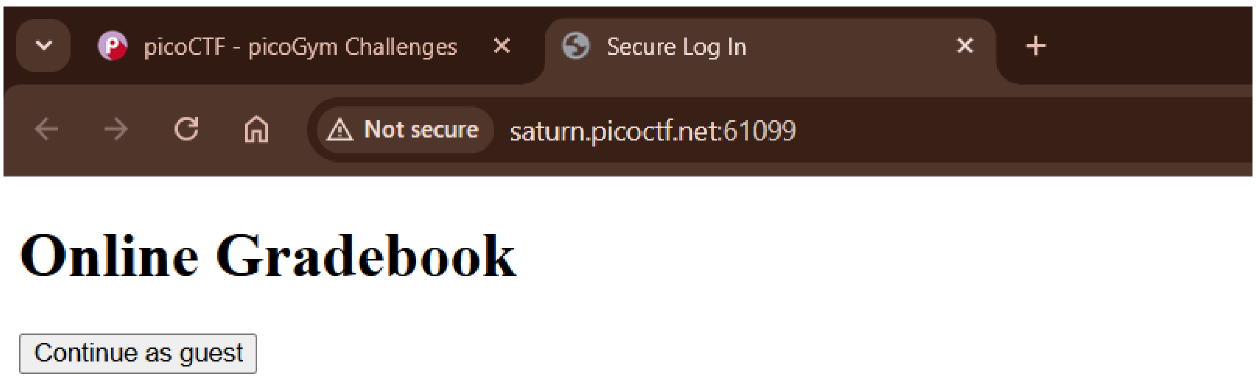
- **Web Browser** - Used to access and interact with the challenge website

- **Browser Developer Tools (Inspect)** - Used to view page structure and cookies

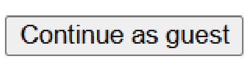
IV. Methodology

1. Launched the challenge instance.

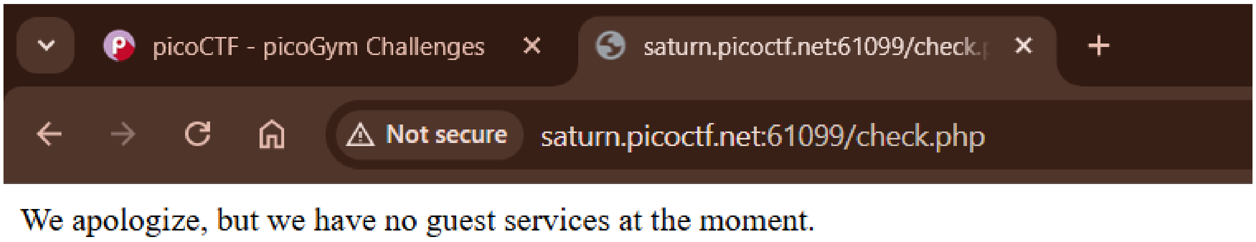
2. Accessed the website using the provided link.
3. Observed the contents of the webpage.



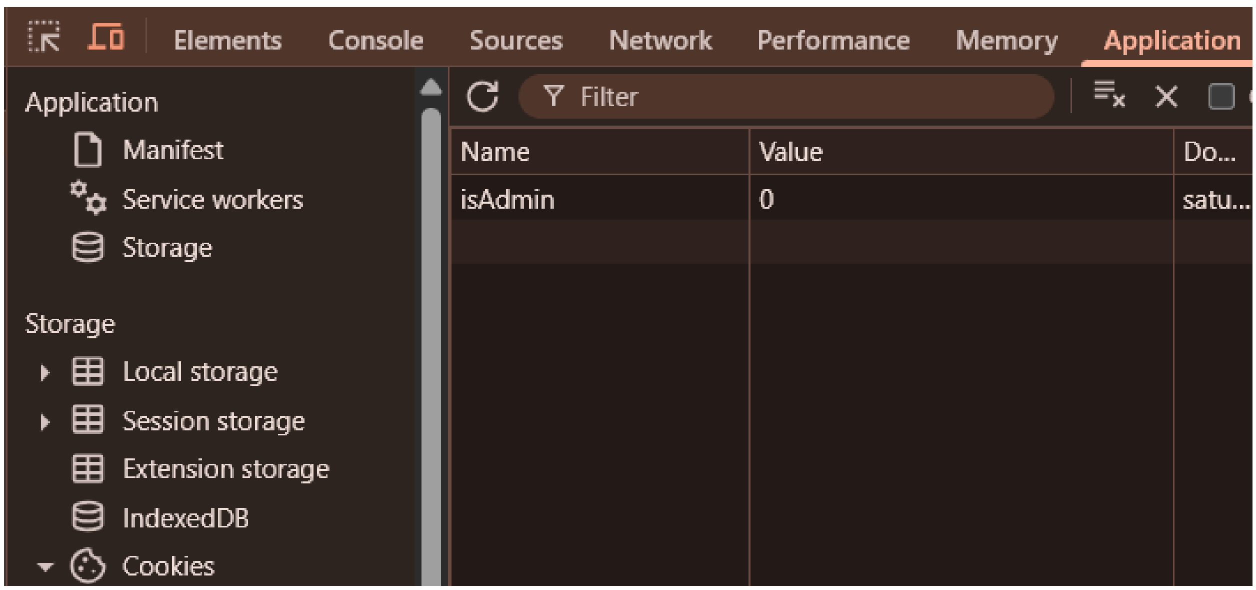
4. Clicked **"Continue as Guest"** to explore the website.



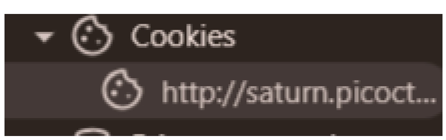
5. The page did not display the flag, suggesting that guest access was limited.



6. Right-clicked on the webpage and selected **Inspect**.
7. Opened the **Application** tab in Developer Tools.



8. Clicked **Cookies** to view stored cookies.



9. Observed a cookie named **isAdmin** with a value of **0**.

Name	Value
isAdmin	0

10. Interpreted that:

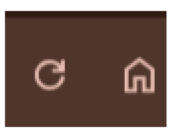
0 = False (Not Admin)

1 = True (Admin)

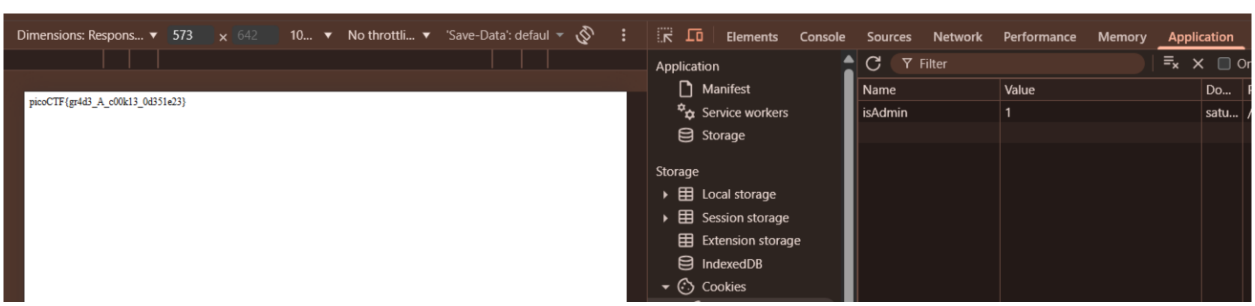
11. Changed the value from **0** to **1**.

Name	Value
isAdmin	1

12. Refreshed the page.

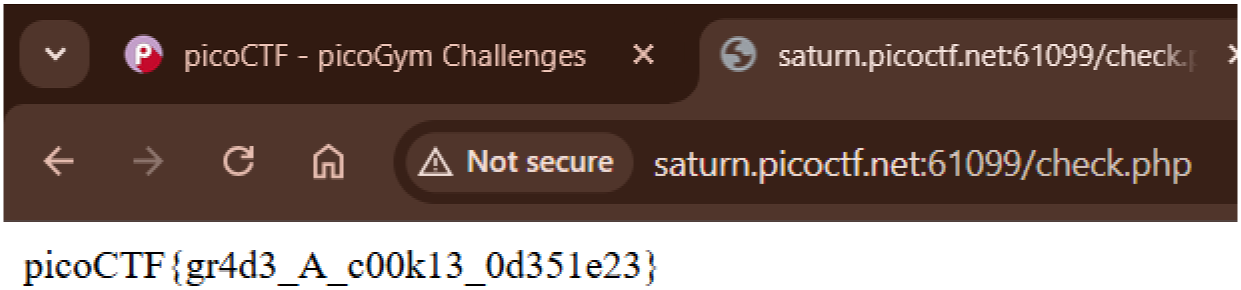


13. The flag was displayed on the webpage.



V. Result

picoCTF{gr4d3_A_c00k13_0d351e23}



VI. Explanation

A cookie is like a **small note that a website gives to your browser.** The note helps the website remember things about you.
For example:

- If you are logged in
- Your name
- Your preference

In this challenge:

The website gave the browser a note that said:

- isAdmin = 0

This means:

- "This user is NOT an admin."

When the value was changed to:

- isAdmin = 1

The website believed that the user was an **administrator**, so it showed the flag.

VII. Conclusion

This challenge demonstrated how insecure cookies can allow users to gain unauthorized access.

It showed that websites should not rely only on cookies to determine permissions.

I learned that cookies can be inspected and modified using browser developer tools, which can sometimes reveal hidden information or allow privilege escalation.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**